

SPECTRAVIDEO USERS GROUP -- Wgtn

Newsletter Number 14 -- September 1985

The next meeting is on Monday ,SEPTEMBER 23rd at 7.30 in the Staff Common Room , Wellington Clinical School , Mein Street Newtown.

There will be a tutorial at 7.00 covering the use of **SOUND**

Following meeting is set for October 21st same time and place.

Wellington SV Users Group

Secretary Darryl Alison Ph 85510 (Paraparaumu)

Treasurer Colin Chin Ph 325656 (hm)

Committee members

Garry Clark 367872

Ross Fletcher

Dennis Timmons 837200

Don Stanley 896379

Specific areas of responsibility for committee members are ...
Don -- newsletter editor/national committee ; Colin -- Treasurer & MSX developments ; Garry -- Radio Access & public domain tape software ; Dennis -- library ; Darryl -- program evaluation committee chairman & Kapiti users rep

Club Subscriptions

The club subscription is now \$15.00/year.

New members this month include Julian Stone, Sean Parsons, G J Leary, Glenn Rosewall, Alan Steadman .

Note that expiry date for subscriptions is printed on the address label of newsletter. Subscriptions not renewed a month after this date will not receive newsletters from then.

Number of Members = 155

Newsletter Contributions

If you are submitting programs to go in the newsletter they MUST satisfy the following conditions or they will NOT be printed.

1 ... be typed/printed on A4 paper with about 5 lines left blank at top and bottom of page and an inch at least around the sides

2 ... typed with a dark ribbon OR printed using emphasized print mode

3 ... include a description of what the program does , typed on A4 paper with example input

4 ... In the case of programs above 20 lines in length they should be sent on cassette , in this case there is no need for the printout as I can merge them into the newsletter. Enclose a stamped addressed envelope for return of cassette

5 ... line numbers should be continuous -- do a RENUM before printing the programs

6 ... PLEASE MAKE SURE THEY WORK . and would readers please note that I am NOT responsible for programs sent by people which do not work .

7 ... In the case of screen dumps from 3d plotters please indicate the function used and try to get the print as dark as possible -- not always easy i know .

All other newsletter contributions should be sent to me at P.O Box 7057 , Wellington South. They may miss being printed for a month if sent to any other box or given to anyone else. Articles should follow 1 and 2 above.

Deadline for Newsletter articles is the 30/31st of each month.

Please follow these guidelines, articles with a 4mm edge all around can not be printed , and neither can articles produced on a dot matrix printer with low resolution . They are simply unreadable after photocopying.

LINE COMMAND

Theres more to LINE than just lines and boxes, especially when you put it together with some of the other SV functions. Try this program out (MSX users change SCREEN1 to SCREEN2)

```
10 SCREEN 1
20 FOR I=0 TO 255 STEP 2
30 LINE (I,I MOD 191)-(255-I,191-I MOD 191),10
```

```

40 NEXT
50 BEEP:FOR I=0 TO 500:NEXT
60 FOR I=0 TO 255 STEP 2
70 LINE (I,I AND 191)-(255-I,191-I XOR 191),10
80 NEXT
90 BEEP:FOR I=0 TO 500:NEXT
100 '
110 ' TRY A FEW OTHER COMBINATIONS OF XOR/OR/AND/MOD/IMP
120 '

```

Discounts for members .. All discounts offered by Einstein Scientific and Microstyle Computers do NOT include hardware. Discounts may be offered on such peripherals as floppy disks, cassettes, books, furniture, printers, monitors but NOT on SpectraVideo hardware. Individual dealers may not offer all the goods above at discounted rates, inquire from the shops just what discounts are available to club members. Note that to obtain a discount on any goods you must produce your current membership card.

GAMES SCORES

Spectron	11710	Robert Campin
Sector Alpha	666400	Gavin Knight
Kung Fu	71405	Garry Clark
	33575	Garry Clark (*)
S C Force	748600	Deirdre Chin
Telebunny	87810	Colin Chin
	26470	Don Stanley (+)
	31670	Kalima Collinson (*)
Omac	35360	Richard Bremford
	25700	Don Stanley (+)
Ninja	136900	Nicola Tuinman
Tetra	284450	Julian Stone
Turboat	68390	Garth Thornton (*)
Turboat	72240	Taane Clark
Sasa	118240	John Tuinman
Frantic Fred	21720	Rachel Hughes (level4)
Flipper Slip	31140	Kalima Collinson (level1)
Bats Alive	3540	Colin Chin (*)
Galaxy	1447	"
Jumping Jack	2600	"
TV Nightmare	7040	"
	3640	" (*)
	4980	Deirdre Chin (+)

(+) = started in normal level

(*) - started in arcade level

otherwise practice level or unknown

Palmerston North Subgroup

The Palmerston North subgroup are holding meetings on the 1st Monday of each month at COMPUTER EXPERIENCE in Palmerston North.

Club Sponsors

Einstein Scientific — 177 Willis Street , Wellington

MicroStyle Computers — 29 High Street, Lower Hutt

Public Domain Software

1) Do NOT send us tapes. We will supply a standard tape which will get round the problem of people sending tapes which are too short.

2) The cost of tapes will be \$3.00 each and we will also have a charge of \$2.50 to cover handling and return postage. This is charged for each separate lot of copying done , not per tape. At present we have 4 complete tapes.

3) Any of the PD Software may also be broadcast on Radio Access in our 5 minute slot on the first Saturday of each month.

4) The tapes will contain combinations of cassette & disk programs , some may be set up for 80 columns. Adapt them as you wish to suit yourself.

5) Send orders with payment to PDS , P.O Box 7057 , Wgtn South, Wellington. Make cheques payable to Garry Clark.

6) Send us your public domain software for inclusion in the software library.

CP/M public domain software has been ordered from the United States Osborne group and should arrive shortly.

People wanting CPM public domain software please write to Deane Whitmore at the Taranaki Users Group who have a large range of CPM pds software. Send formatted CPM disks and a stamped addressed envelope and please give them a couple of weeks before you start moaning about not having received them. Address is 3 Lombardy Place , New Plymouth.

THANKS

Theres a lot of people who work behind the scenes to help get the

magazine ready each month. Heres some acknowledgement for the printers at broadcasting who are so prompt with printing when they get the newsletter , to Karen who helps me label them and staple them , to Dennis who posts them out from the hospital and Garry who races around town collecting them and returning them to me. Thanks folks .

The ZORK assistance line ...

try saying "hello sailor"

Overseas Developments

The MSX disk/cassette from Australia will only work on MSX programs which do not use their own I/O , ie that work exclusively through the ROMS for I/O . The following programs will not work .. ZAXXON,HUSTLER, we will attempt to check others, ZEN works fine.

In the middle pages of this newsletter you will find information on the SV-Xpress which is due for European release on September 21st. There is no indication of when (or if) it will be released in new Zealand.

Wanted to Buy

1 ... programs for the stock exchange ; and also family tree programs. Please ring Garry Clark , phone number at start of newsletter.

Machine Code Corner

For those of you interested in graphics in machine code here are a few decoded ROM routines.

... to do a screen command in MC

```
SCREEN 1 ...      LD      A,1
                  LD      (FE3A),A
                  CALL    3610
```

```
SCREEN 2 ...      LD      A,2
                  LD      (FE3A),A
                  CALL    3665
```

```

SCREEN 0 ...      LD      A,0
                  LD      (FE3A),A
                  CALL    3541

```

... to set up sprite size (called AFTER the screen mode is set)

```

16x16 sprites ... LD      A,2
                  LD      (FE3B),A
                  CALL    36BE

```

```

32x32 sprites ... LD      A,3
                  LD      (FE3B),A
                  CALL    36BE

```

default is 8x8 sprites. To set this up if it has been redefined use

```

                  LD      A,1
                  LD      (FE3B),A
                  CALL    36BE

```

... to switch the function key display off/on

```

OFF              LD      A,0
                  CALL    45CB

```

```

ON               LD      A,1
                  CALL    45CB

```

... to do a PSET

```

load the colour into FA13
load X pixel into BC register
load Y pixel into DE register
CALL      2338

```

... to do a LINE

```

load top left X pixel in BC
load top left Y pixel in DE

```

```

bottom right X pixel should be
in both FE42/43 and FE46/47
bottom right Y pixel should be
in both FE44/45 and FE48/49

```

colour of box/line in FA13

```

LINE            CALL    243C
SOLID BOX       CALL    2401
BOX             CALL    2452

```

Notes from Last Meeting

Ross presented a hardware review of an MS-DOS board which can be plugged into z80 systems and which allows the user to toggle between CPM and MS-DOS and transfer files between the two. The board contains all hardware (inc 256k ram) and software necessary and can be used as a RAM disk for your CPM system. These have to be purchased from Australia at present and should according to Ross operate on the SV.

We split the meeting up into two groups for beginners/advanced which seemed to work out fairly well. Next meeting Darryl will take the beginners group. It would be very advantageous if people attending the beginners group could think about how they would like this to operate.

Software Reviews

(1) ZEN... this assembler/disassembler/monitor is written by KUMA for MSX. For SV328 owners wanting an assembler we can make a SV copy available provided you can supply proof of purchase of an MSX copy.

ZEN provides a text editor to enter lines of MC, complete with labels of any length, comments, and a very fast assembly time (the manual claims 4000 line per minute). It boasts a monitor which includes the ability to examine the registers (you can only examine these in hex) which can be done after setting a break-point to see what the program is up to.

The disassembler and the assembler both share the same work space, and the disassembler can not always be used after an assemble due to this work space being full. However also provided is a more elementary disassembler which gets round this to some extent. The disassembler allows disassembled code to be appended to the MC program currently being worked on, and generates its own labels.

The usual facilities of a monitor such as filling memory, examining memory are available, as well as setting the program counter to any address. A cassette interface is provided to read/write ascii files (assembler programs) or to read/write blocks of memory.

Overall I find ZEN very easy to use but a little limiting with its primitive editing facilities (but then it is designed to let you use as big a program as possible and many frills are omitted from it). It is well worth having for anyone interested in MC. MSX copies of ZEN can be purchased from MICROSTYLE COMPUTERS.

(2) SPEC-MON — this is a monitor on a cartridge which gives very extensive monitor facilities but regreably offers no

ability to assemble code. Features include the ability to read/write Colour Genie, TRS80, System-80 and MicroBee tapes as well as SVI (The author is considering adding MSX tapes also); trace a program line by line (not available in ZEN); search for an opcode in RAM or for an ascii string in RAM; disassemble; calculate jump rrelative amounts ... and much more.

The author was good enough to let me loan a copy for this review. The first thing is that as a cartridge it will not be cheap. (A cartridge costs about \$40 for the raw parts in NZ). It is a breeze to use and very flexible with its ability to move code around and compare/exchange blocks of memory at will. In fact you can move a block and the program will even update jumps and so on to run in the new location -- very nice touch. It features an on board help system, type a command then press F2 and you get a screen of help information -- another nice touch. The ability to boot BASIC/CPM with the cartridge in is also present, which means you can transfer files fairly easily if you locate them in the right place (all explained in the very comprehensive documentation).

Overall I found SPEC-MON to be an excellent monitor system offering all a monitor should plus much more. However the lack of even a single line assembler causes problems, but if used together with ZEN and the cassette interfaces this can be overcome.

SPEC-MON is not yet on the market but will be shortly. ZEN costs \$56.95. Together they make up an excellent machine code programming system.

Treasurers Report

The treasure told me his report would be presented at the last meeting but he did not turn up. The report has not been forthcoming for this newsletter either.

Question & Answer

If anyone knows how to alter the 80 Column Card character set could they please let us know for the newsletter. Also does anyone know how to change Wordstar to let it use the RIGHT/LEFT graph characters.

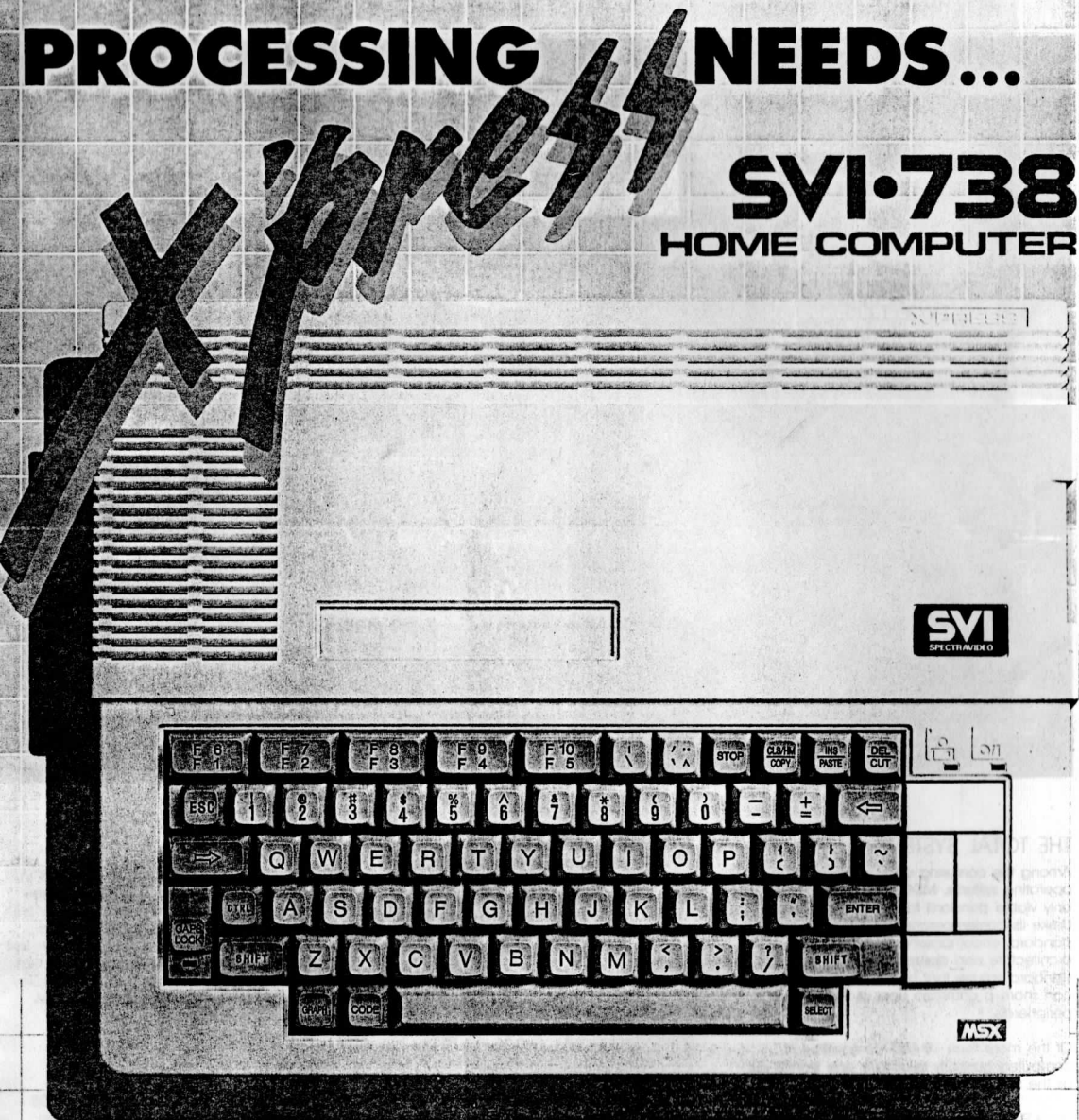
Pins 5 and 9 on the joystick ports are accessed as follows.

Pin 5 of joystick 1	-- X=INP(&H98) AND 1
9	-- X=INP(&H98) AND 2
5	2 -- X=INP(&H98) AND 4
9	-- X=INP(&H98) AND 8

Thanks to Garth Thornton

THE PRACTICAL ANSWER TO YOUR INFORMATION PROCESSING NEEDS...

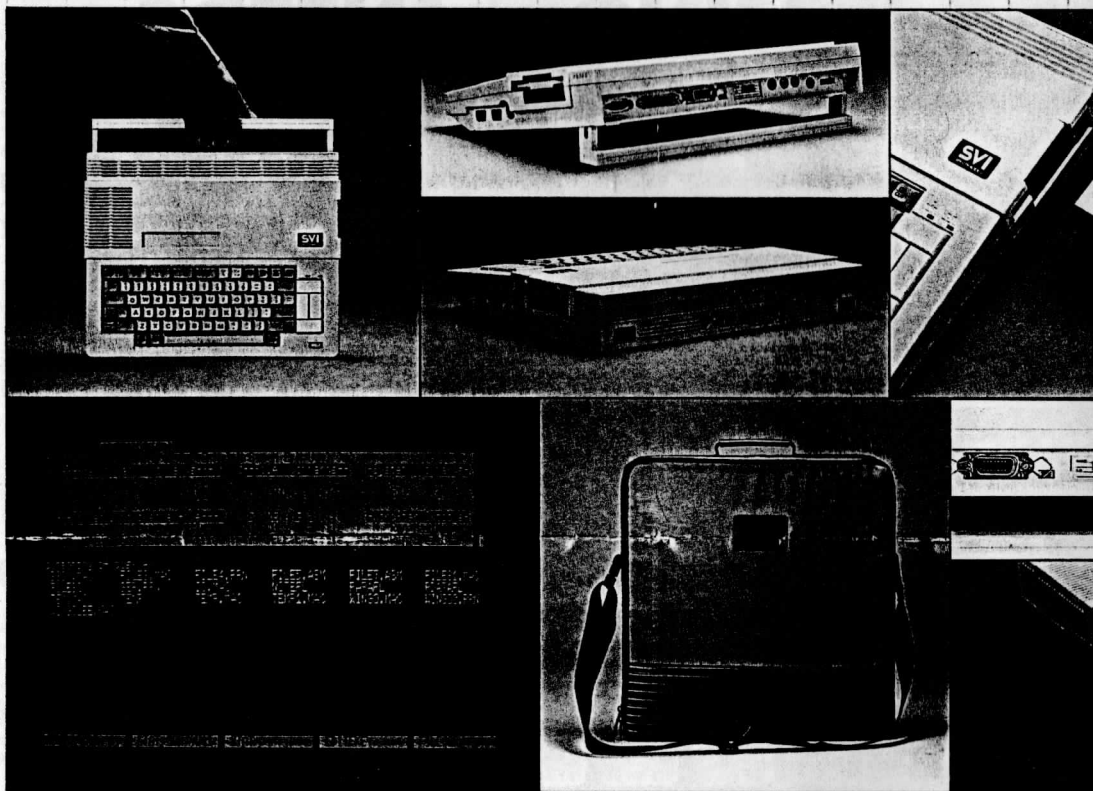
SVI-738
HOME COMPUTER



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MSX

CATCH THE X'PRESS TO INNOVATION



THE TOTAL SYSTEM

Among the confusing array of microcomputer operating systems, MSX has emerged as the only viable standard for home computers. Unlike its contemporaries, MSX is a full-fledged standard, encompassing both hardware architecture and operating system. Thus, this standard ensures that all compatible machines can share a common pool of software and peripherals.

Of the more than 10 MSX-compatible computers currently available, one stands out as the serious user's choice.

The X'PRESS is an enhanced MSX computer system capable of performing useful applications. In fact, all the essential hardware is integrated in one attractive, ergonomically-designed console.

In addition to the standard MSX features, the X'PRESS includes a built-in 3.5" Microfloppy disk drive; switchable 80- and 40-column display; full-stroke 73-key keyboard; 80K of random-access memory; two general-purpose I/O ports; enlarged cursor control keys; multi-purpose retractable handle; and carrying case.

More than just a game machine, the X'PRESS is a versatile computer with many real-world applications. It can run MSX Disk BASIC, MSX-DOS and CP/M software and it can be connected to the many RS-232-C or Centronics-type parallel devices.

The practical answer to your information-processing needs, the X'PRESS is ready and capable of becoming a fundamental part of your life.

DISPLAY

The X'PRESS employs state-of-the-art technology to provide a variable screen display. A recent development, a new video Display Processor (MVDP), allows switching between 40- and 80-column modes, as well as low, medium, and high resolution graphics. The 80-column display is especially useful when running CP/M, since most CP/M programs need 80 characters per line.

RAM

Boasting a more-than-adequate 80,000 characters of random-access memory (RAM), the X'PRESS can accommodate the most demanding user. There's enough room to execute sophisticated applications software and to store mountains of information.

INNOVATIVE COMPUTER APPLICATIONS



DISK DRIVE

Integrated in the console, the 3.5" Microfloppy Disk Drive furnishes an additional 360 Kilo-bytes of memory. Unlike RAM, it stores data on interchangeable Microfloppy diskettes. Three operating environments, CP/M, MSX-DOS, and MSX Disk BASIC, provide access to a broad selection of software. The Microfloppy Disk Drive is a fast, accurate, and reliable storage device, which ensures safe retention of information stored by the computer.

KEYBOARD

The keyboard is your link with the computer. The X'PRESS keyboard is similar to that of a typewriter, but has a lot more keys, 73 in all. Incorporating the standard QWERTY keys for data entry with function keys for one-stroke command input, and enlarged arrow keys for easy cursor control, the keyboard allows rapid interplay between you and the computer.

INPUT/OUTPUT PORTS

Three ports at the back of the console facilitate system expansion. You can connect your computer to a modem, a RS-232-C or parallel printer, or a second disk drive without the addition of expansive interface cartridges or communication software.

SOFTWARE

Besides the three operating systems, a number of useful utility programs are provided to help you take full advantage of the special features built into the X'PRESS. Bundled FREE with the computer are programs for transferring files through the RS-232-C port, conversing with other computers, and defining the function keys.

CARRYING CASE

A matching padded-nylon carrying case is included, FREE-OF-CHARGE, with the X'PRESS system. It can be carried either by hand or slung over the shoulder. What's more, its tough, yet elegant, exterior protects the computer against damage due to dust, rough treatment, etc.

Bring an X'PRESS into your home or office. Call 1-800-4-A-PC to learn more about the X'PRESS to innovative computer applications.

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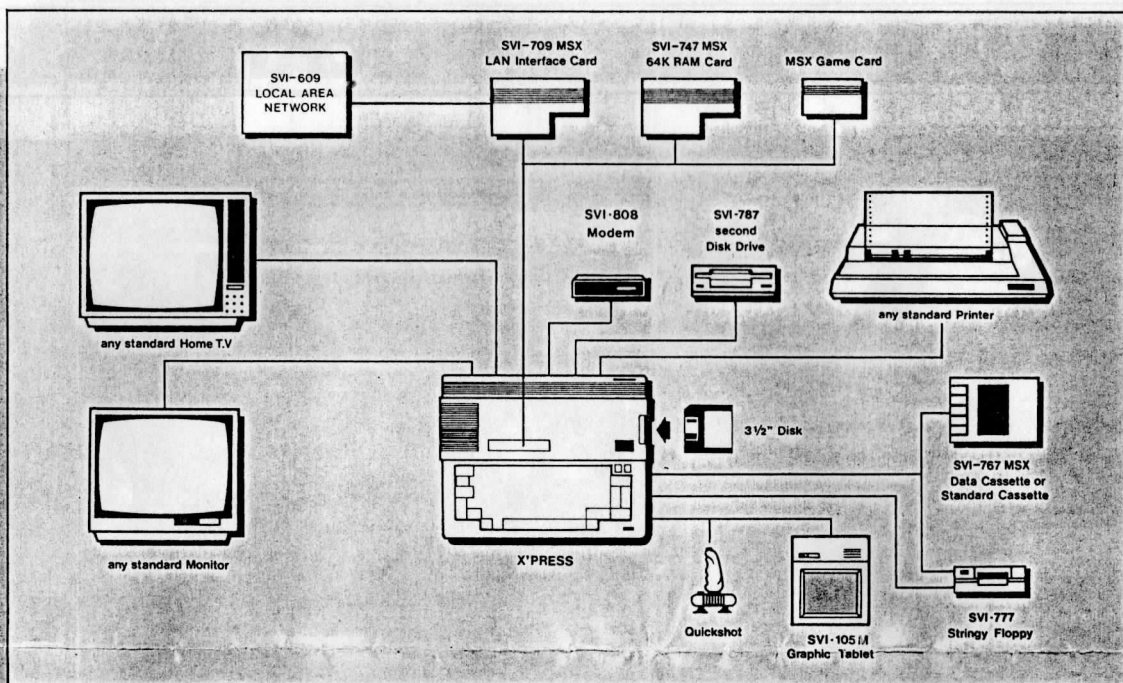
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Bring an X'PRESS into your home or office. Carry the X'PRESS to innovative computer applications.

VE
ORIGINAL

THE X'PRESS PROVIDES GREAT POTENTIAL FOR EXPANSION



QUICKSHOT MSX JOYSTICK

Spectravideo has improved the design of the award-winning "QuickShot I" joystick to incorporate a second fire button. The grip is sleekly contoured and comfortable. The four removable suction cups on the base of the controller bring more excitement and an arcade flavor to your game play.

SVI-709 NETWORK INTERFACE CARD

This cartridge transforms your computer into a station in the SVI-609 Local Area Network. Each station can make use of a portion of the SVI-609's 10M-byte hard disk for its own file storage area, printer spooler, and software library.

SVI-767 MSX DATA CASSETTE

This inexpensive device uses ordinary cassette tape to add storage and retrieval capability to your computer system. The built-in Automatic Level Control (ALC) ensures reliable and high-quality recording. Tape counter, LED indicator and auto-stop are standard features.

SVI-777 STRINGY FLOPPY DRIVE

Employing an advanced tape drive, the Stringy Floppy Drive adds up to 80K of long-term storage. This inexpensive device, controlled by its own operating system, stores files on rugged, compact cartridges, called Microwafers™. Fast, accurate, file storage and retrieval are a snap with the Stringy Floppy.

SVI-747 MSX 64K RAM EXPANSION CARTRIDGE

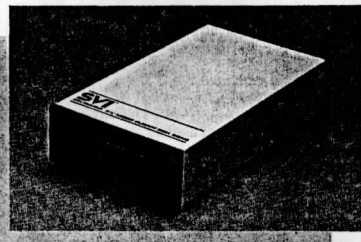
An extra 64K RAM memory space to meet your growing need for more complex applications. It plugs into the cartridge or cartridge expansion slot of all MSX computers.

SVI-808 MODEM

A power yet easy-to-use device for communicating with other computers through the telephone lines.

SVI-787 MICROFLOPPY DISK DRIVE

Matching the EXPRESS in color, design and performance, the SVI-787 is the perfect complement to your computer system. This 3-1/2 inch disk drive doubles the long-term storage capacity of your computer. And it works with all three popular microcomputer operating systems: MSX-DOS, CP/M, and MSX Disk BASIC.



*The features & specifications are subject to change without prior notice.

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DEGREES AND RADIANS ON THE SPECTRAVIDEO

An understanding of Radian measure is necessary for using the CIRCLE command to its full potential, and for many areas in graphics programmes.

One radian is the angle when the arc on the outside of the circle is equal to the radius.

0 radians is 0 degrees, and is directly to the right of the centre of the circle. π radians is 180 degrees, and 2π radians is 360 degrees, or the same as 0. $\pi/2$ is 90 degrees, and $3\pi/2$ is 270 degrees.

For a conversion between the two, divide the degrees by roughly 57.295779 to get radians, and vice versa.

The circle command takes the following form:

CIRCLE (X,Y),RADIUS,COLOUR,START,END,ASPECT

The START and END points are in radians, and an arc is drawn between the two. If START is 0 and END is π , then the top of a circle will be drawn.

An example program follows, in which you enter the angle from the x-axis and it will draw the line.

```
1 SCREEN0:PRINT"Degrees or Radians (D or R)?";I$=INPUT$(1):PRINT:PRINT:IF I$="d" OR I$="D" THEN
N INPUT"Angle in degrees";DEG ELSE INPUT"Angle in radians";RAD:ANG=6,2831853#-RAD:GOTO 3
2 ANG=6,2831853#-DEG/57,29577866661#
3 COLOR 11,0,0:SCREEN 1
4 LINE(128,15)-(128,170),15:LINE(30,96)-(225,96),15
5 IF I$<>"D" AND I$<>"d" THEN LOCATE 0,93:PRINT"3.14":LOCATE 230,93:PRINT"0":LOCATE 120,5:PR
INT"1.57":LOCATE 120,180:PRINT"4.72" ELSE LOCATE 0,93:PRINT"180":LOCATE 230,93:PRINT"0":LOC
ATE 123,5:PRINT"90":LOCATE 120,180:PRINT"270"
6 LINE(128,96)-(128+COS(ANG)*80,96+SIN(ANG)*80)
7 I$=INPUT$(1):RUN
```

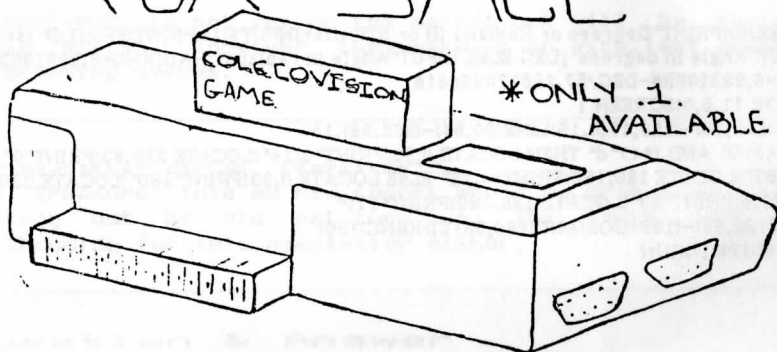
I will just point out, for the benefit of other disk uses, the most amazingly stupid thing about SV DOS. When inputting from a text file in BASIC, it is not necessary to CLOSE the file after use. However, sometimes it is. If you then change disks and save your BASIC program, then change disks back again and type CLOSE, the disk you saved onto will now have a Bad Allocation Table, and very few of the files will be recoverable. I doubt this is the only cause of Allocation Table errors, but it is certainly one of them.

To the Editor,

I wish to thank you and all the others who work at getting the Newsletter out. The articles are very informative making the Newsletter a worthwhile publication. I'd also like to thank the Editor for his patience and help when 'us beginners' call with problems.

CZ

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MSX Software available includes the ZEN assembler

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<< ===== MICROSTYLE COMPUTERS ===== >>

LONG, LONG CONVERSE, AND CP/M

PART THE FIRST

No I am not kidding. Until five years ago, unless you had access to someone's UNIX machine, or something using a Basic-based operating system, CP/M was the only viable disk operating system around. By viable I mean a system that you could actually get software for.

CP/M was written in the 1970s (don't ask me exactly when) by Gary Kiddall, who went on to found the firm Digital Research. CP/M was written on an Intel MDS (Microcomputer Development System), an 8080 based machine still available today.

We are lucky, because our Spectravideos use the Z80 chip, which is upwardly compatible with the old 8080.

CP/M is what is known as a Disk Operating System, which is another way of saying that it is an interface between you (the USER), and the data and programs that are on your precious disks.

This series is not for the casual user, who only uses CP/M when he is using Wordstar or dBaseII. It is aimed at the user who is more interested in what goes on inside the machine, and how to make it do what he (whoops... or she) wants (ve haf vays of making your.....).

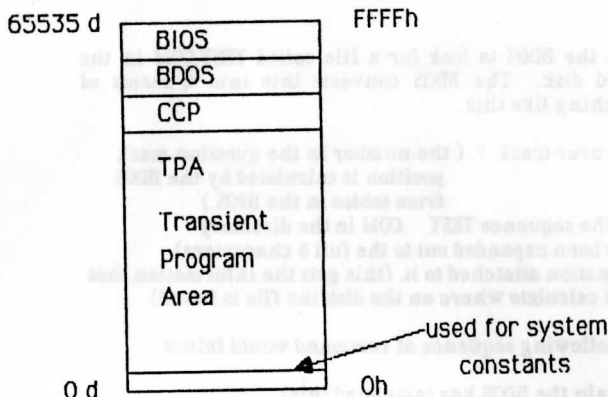
CP/M is composed of three main modules the CCP, the BDOS and the BIOS. We will look at each of these in greater detail. Refer to the memory map of a typical CP/M machine to see where they sit in memory.

CCP

CCP stands for **C**onsole **C**ommand **P**rocessor. This is quite a complicated program in its own right, handling all the interaction between the machine and you. The CCP is the part of CP/M that lets you backspace when you make typing errors (yes even that small function had to be coded), use wildcard characters in filenames (the * and ?) and assorted other housekeeping chores at the same time. The CCP is the same on all CP/M systems, no matter what computer you use. It's main job is to convert your requests into commands that are passed to the other parts of CP/M (see below) for action.

BDOS

BDOS stands for **B**asic **D**isk **O**perating **S**ystem. This rather large chunk of code is again the same on all CP/M systems. It handles all the standard things that the system does with disks, without getting down to the nitty gritty.



BIOS

BIOS stands for **Basic Input/Output System**. This is the code that is unique to every system. The format of this code is laid down in the Digital Research manuals (if you can ever understand them...these manuals are renowned for their difficulty), but how the code is written for each computer depends entirely on the individual doing the writing. Above I mentioned the nitty gritty; well the BIOS is only concerned with the nitty gritty.

Lets take for an example the simple command of wanting to run a program called TEST.COM on drive A:, and you are already logged onto drive A:.

You type TEST followed by the ENTER key on the keyboard. The characters are read from the keyboard by the BIOS (the bit that looks after all the hardware remember), and passed one by one to the CCP (the bit that looks after you). When the CCP sees the ENTER, it looks at the sequence TEST for any invalid characters. At this stage the CCP also changes any lowercase characters into upper case. CP/M is an old system, designed when lowercase equipment was not so readily available, and all commands and filenames are handled internally as upper case. The CCP makes an assumption about what you wanted. Because you did not put an extension after the filename (i.e. you did not type the .COM or anything else), the CCP automatically appends a .COM to the end of your command.

The CCP now issues a command to the BDOS to look for a file called TEST.COM in the directory of the currently logged disk. The BDOS converts this into a series of commands to the BIOS that go something like this...

Position the heads of the disk drive over track ? (the number in the question mark position is calculated by the BDOS from tables in the BIOS.)

Search for the first occurrence of the sequence TEST .COM in the directory
(note that the filename has been expanded out to the full 8 characters)

If it is found, give me all the information attached to it. (this gets the information that will enable the BDOS to calculate where on the disk the file is found)

After doing the calculations the following sequence of command would follow

Position the heads over track ? (again the BDOS has calculated this)
Read track(s) xyz etc (these are still part of the above calculations)
into memory starting at location 100h (256 decimal).
and this is continued until all the file is read in.

The BDOS then give the program complete control of the computer by jumping to location 100h, and you program takes over. There is nothing to stop you program using the memory that the CCP sits in, because when your program finishes, the BDOS will automatically reload the CCP into memory, and then give it control.

So you see that quite a lot goes on in the computer before your program (TEST) even starts to run. That's all for this month, see you later.

Note from the EDITOR

As some of you will be aware I and several others are in the process of starting up a software house in Wellington. We will be offering support to SVI/MSX, as well as new developments in CPM and also supporting MS and PC-DOS.

As a result of this I am having to withdraw from the position of Chairman of the National Committee, which was only an interim appointment. If anyone is interested in the position of Chairman or wishes to nominate someone for this position, please inform me ASAP. I will also have a lot less time available for the newsletter. If someone is interested in taking this over (I will still write articles) please let me know ASAP also. If no-one comes forward ...

I would be very interested in hearing from anyone who wishes to sell software for SVI/MSX. Please send a tape, plus DOCUMENTATION to me at Box 7057, Wellington South. Royalty payments will be very competitive, and will be based on a sliding scale which means the royalty will increase as more copies are sold. And the name of the company ... TOTAL COMPUTER SOLUTIONS. By the way, in order to sell as many copies as possible, we will attempt wherever possible to convert SVI programs to MSX and vice versa, thus adding to the potential market.

Don Stanley

FROM A BEGINNERS NOTES:

Instructions in Wordstar are fairly straight forward when one wants to copy a file to a new file name, but I came across a problem in copying a file from one work disk to another work disk. The method I finally worked out was:

IN OPENING MENU

Program disk in drive A
Source work disk in drive B
Press O to copy a file
Name of File to copy from: B:filename
Name of file to copy to: A:filename (note this is the program disk)

then:

remove disk in disk drive B, place destination disk in drive B and repeat the above method transferring the file from the program disk to the destination disk, then deleting the file on the program disk. I found that I couldn't work the COPY function without the program disk in drive A, and the equipment wouldn't accept the removal of a disk and the replacement of another during copying function as it read the file to be copied in bits and pieces.

NOTE: that the disk you are copying from must have SYSGEN on it.

DELETING FILES ON WORDSTAR

To delete a file you can change your logged drive to the drive the file is on or just put the file 'letter' and a colon before the file name.

WRITING BLOCKS

Writing a block in Wordstar is o.k. as long as SYSGEN is on the disk in drive B and the program disk in drive A.

MOST PROBLEMS YOU ENCOUNTER IN WORDSTAR AND OTHER STAR PRODUCTS ARE IN THE MANUALS. JUST READ THEM.

We had trouble getting our system to copy the master WS disk through the normal function. Don instructed us in the Pip way, but now I have egg on my face as I have recently found it adequately explained in the Datastar book. Thanks anyway Don for saving hours of frustration.

CZ

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